

AXON

Vehicle Intelligence

Built for Public Safety. Governed for Accountability.

Privacy, security, and compliance across Axon Vehicle Intelligence.

Agencies own and control their ALPR data. Sharing is explicit, permission-based, and revocable. Lawful requests go through the agency for read and hit data, not Axon. Retention is short, configurable, and automatically enforced. Every action is logged in immutable audit logs that hold up in a council chamber, a courtroom, or an oversight review.

That is the foundation Fleet 3, Outpost, and Lightpost are validated by independent third-party assessments, and proven across years of mobile ALPR deployments. The pages that follow show how it works in practice.

At a glance

Data ownership
Agencies own and control their ALPR data. Axon does not pool, resell, or independently disclose it.

Sharing
Off by default. Invite-only, visible, time-bound, and revocable.

Lawful requests
Routed to the agency as the data owner. Axon does not independently disclose customer data.

Federal access
No back door, no centralized pool. No automatic or standing federal access.

Retention
Agency-configured and automatically enforced. Non-evidentiary ALPR data purge per policy.

Audit
Every access logged with user, action, time, and stated reason, in immutable audit logs.

1. Your data, your control

Agencies own and control their ALPR data. Axon does not pool, resell, or independently disclose agency data. The eight points below are how that principle is implemented in practice.

Data ownership

The agency owns and controls its ALPR data. Axon does not have access to agency data and does not use agency data for any other purpose, including resale or independent analysis. Any external request for data, including subpoenas, warrants, or FOIA requests, would be directed to the agency itself, and the agency would determine how to respond under applicable law and its own policies.

Cross-agency sharing

Cross-agency sharing capabilities are planned for Q3 2026. Sharing relationships will be invite-only, visible, and revocable. Every relationship will be managed in the agency's Axon environment and will require an explicit invitation. Shared access will not create copies of records, recipient agencies will not take ownership, and there will be no national lookup or unrestricted network.

Lawful requests

Legal process requests are directed to the agency, and every step is logged. If a subpoena, warrant, or FOIA request is directed to Axon, we object and route it to the agency as the data owner. Axon Evidence audit logs preserve each step so councils and oversight bodies can confirm lawful procedures were followed.

Retention

Agencies set retention, and data is purged automatically. ALPR data is transferred into the agency's secure instance of Axon Evidence, where retention periods are configured. Non-evidentiary ALPR data is automatically deleted per agency policy. Axon provides recommended defaults, and agencies configure and control the settings themselves.

Access tracking

Every access is recorded, including who accessed the data, what actions were taken, and when access occurred. Immutable audit logs in Axon Evidence capture the user, action, time, and, when configured, the stated reason for access. Both Axon Evidence and Fusus provide audit capabilities that allow agencies to review activity at any time.

Sharing controls

Sharing is off by default, configurable based on agency policy, revocable, and can be time-bound. Sharing does not involve copying or redistributing ALPR data. Access is federated, allowing recipient agencies to query authorized data without taking ownership, and access can be revoked immediately by the donor agency.

AI model training

Axon may use transformed ALPR data from customers who have opted to participate in Axon's Customer Experience Improvement Program (ACEIP). Full plate reads are not used. Customers may opt out at any time by contacting aceip@axon.com.

Federal access

There is no back door or centralized pool for federal access. Any federal access requires either valid legal process directed to the agency or an agency-approved sharing relationship. Even when a sharing relationship exists, the agency must approve the request before data is shared. All access is permissioned and logged.

Transparency

Agencies receive access to the ALPR Policy and Usage Transparency Portal in Axon Evidence, which can be configured to publish retention policies, usage metrics, and program details on a public-facing website. Agencies control what is published and may disable the portal at any time.

2. Built to be secure

Axon ALPR cameras are engineered as field-deployable platforms with built-in protections aligned to Axon's Secure by Design principles, validated by internal testing and independent third-party assessments.

Device security and hardware integrity

- **Secure boot:** Each stage of the boot process is cryptographically validated; only Axon-signed firmware runs on the device.
- **Encrypted storage:** AES-256 encrypted partition with hardware-backed key protection covers ALPR reads, context video, authentication tokens, configuration files, and logs.
- **Physical security:** Physical interfaces (e.g., USB) support only approved functions and are locked against interactive access.
- **Controlled firmware and updates:** OTA firmware packages are cryptographically signed and validated before installation. Third-party penetration testing is performed under Axon's Trust & Assurance program.

Secure access and role management

- **Device access:** Devices have no exposed local login interface; configuration occurs through authenticated Axon workflows. Pairing requires authenticated provisioning via Axon's installer with signed tokens and encrypted channels.
- **Agency access controls:** Through Axon Evidence and Fusus, agencies assign to the device role-based permissions, enforce least-privilege access (including export and retention restrictions), and use SSO and MFA to align with their authentication standards.
- **Audit and accountability:** Every action, user activity, access attempts, configuration changes, sharing decisions, data exports, is recorded in immutable audit logs to maintain evidentiary integrity.

Data and network security

- **Data in transit:** TLS 1.2+ with cryptographic modules protects uploads to Axon Evidence and Fusus. Devices authenticate using hardware-protected certificates and signed tokens, preventing spoofing.
- **Data at rest:** AES-256 encryption protects all stored data.
- **Network defenses:** Firewall enforcement permits only essential outbound communication; inbound interfaces are restricted by default. Store-and-forward reliability buffers ALPR data on encrypted storage if connectivity is lost.

ALPR audit capability:

Beginning April 2026, agencies have access to a one-button ALPR audit report built directly into Axon Fusus.

The report is designed to make compliance reporting easy, repeatable, and defensible. It captures officer-level access activity including user identity, the action taken, timestamp, and the stated reason for each ALPR access. It'll also show activity by external agencies with whom you decide to share your ALPR data, when ALPR Sharing launches in Q3 2026.

The report is built for supervisory review, internal affairs, and oversight bodies that require full accountability detail. For external sharing such as FOIA requests, agencies can choose to remove PII and investigative details like officer name, plate number, and case number etc. before sharing the report. This pulls the data from the same immutable audit log infrastructure that underlies all of Axon Evidence.

3. Where Axon stands apart

> The most important distinction is not the camera, it is how the system is structured after data is captured. Architecture determines exposure boundaries; configuration determines governance posture.

Design area	Agency-controlled model (Axon)	Shared / network-based model
Where data lives	Within an agency-controlled environment.	May be stored or accessed through shared or network-accessible environments.
Who can see data	Visibility unchanged unless the agency takes explicit action.	Visibility may expand based on participation, configuration, or system features.
How data is shared	Explicit, relationship-based sharing defined by the agency.	May be enabled through participation or system features.
Federal access	No back door or centralized pool for federal access. Any federal access requires a valid legal process directed to the agency or an agency-approved sharing relationship, and the agency must approve each request before data is shared.	Network-based architectures may create centralized data pools where legal process can be directed to the vendor rather than solely to the originating agency. Federal access pathways have been a documented focus of public scrutiny in this category.
Who can access	Limited to direct, authorized relationships.	May include indirect pathways such as partner agencies or shared query layers.
Retention	System-enforced based on agency policy.	Policy-defined with variable enforcement; exported data may persist outside controls.
Disclosure control	Agency retains full control.	May involve multiple entities.
Access tracking	Agency can directly review and explain all access.	Visibility into access may depend on system structure.
If something goes wrong	Issues typically contained to a single agency environment.	Impact scope may extend beyond one agency.
Independent validation	SOC 2 Type II, ISO 27001, ISO 27701, FedRAMP High, CJIS, see trust.axon.com.	Varies by vendor.

Agencies have used Fleet for years to deploy mobile ALPR responsibly, and that same foundation carries forward across fixed and mobile ALPR, sharing remains explicit, revocable, and fully auditable, whether the camera is in a patrol vehicle, on a roadside pole, or integrated into streetlight infrastructure. Adding fixed ALPR to an existing Fleet 3 deployment does not introduce a separate governance model: ALPR data flow into the same agency-controlled environment under the same retention, access, sharing, and audit controls.

Answers to the questions headlines are raising

> Some of the most-asked questions in council chambers today come from headlines about other vendors in this category. Here is how Axon Vehicle Intelligence is structured to answer those questions directly.

Does Axon maintain a national pool of ALPR data?

No. ALPR data stays within the agency's environment unless the agency chooses to share it. There is no automatic cross-agency access, and the system does not connect to a national database. When an agency does choose to share, that access is limited, visible, and can be changed or revoked at any time. Nothing is shared by default, and agencies can only share data they own.

Can federal agencies automatically access our ALPR data?

No. The platform does not provide automatic or built-in access to any federal agency. There are no built-in pathways that route data outside the agency's controlled environment. Any request from a federal entity, like any other external request, would be directed to the agency itself, and the agency would determine how to respond based on its own policies and applicable law. Federal agencies do not receive automatic or standing access.

Can Axon disclose our agency's data without our permission?

No. The agency owns and controls its ALPR data. Axon does not have routine access to agency ALPR data and does not independently disclose it to any outside party. Subpoenas, warrants, and FOIA requests are routed to the agency as the data owner, and the agency determines how to respond based on its own policies and applicable law. All activity is logged so councils and oversight bodies can confirm lawful procedures were followed.

Is governance enforced by design or just by policy?

By design. Agency ownership, explicit sharing, enforceable retention, and immutable audit logs are built into the platform from the ground up, not added on top after the fact.

Can we use our own hotlists?

Axon supports both NCIC and agency-owned hotlists in a single platform. Axon pulls the NCIC hotlist on a daily cycle. Agencies can upload and manage their own hotlists directly in Evidence.com, with updates propagating to devices in minutes, giving agencies real-time control without depending on external update cycles. All hotlist data is encrypted in transit.

What this means in a council conversation

When an agency walks into a hearing on ALPR, the questions that decide the room are predictable: Where does our data live? Who can see it? Can it be shared without our permission? How long is it kept? Can a federal entity access it? Who is accountable when something goes wrong? Axon Vehicle Intelligence is structured so each of those questions has a clear, specific, system-enforced answer, not a policy promise layered over an architecture that allows otherwise.

Resources

Vehicle Intelligence overview: axon.com/products/vehicle-intelligence.

Trust, security certifications, and supporting documentation: trust.axon.com.

Axon Customer Experience Improvement Program: axon.com/aceip.

Axon cloud Services Policy: axon.com/legal/cloud-services-privacy-policy.

Responsible Innovation framework: axon.com/responsibility/responsible-innovation.

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